

Appendix — Glossary of Key Terms

New vocabulary appears fast in Lab 1. Use this table as a quick reference while you work; each term is also explained in context in the Guided Walkthrough.

Area	Term	What it means
Product & process	Vertical slice	A thin feature that runs through every layer (UI → API → database) to prove the whole stack works together.
	Engineering contract	The specification PLUS the evidence (tests, acceptance criteria) required to prove it is complete.
	Acceptance criteria	The specific, checkable conditions an Issue must meet before it is accepted as done.
	Definition of Done	The checklist that marks work truly finished: merged via PR, tests passing, documented.
Web stack	Frontend / Backend	The browser-side app (React) versus the server program (Express) it talks to over HTTP.
	REST API	A style where the backend answers HTTP requests sent to URLs called endpoints.
	Endpoint	One URL + method the API answers, e.g. GET /api/health.
	JSON	The plain-text format used to exchange data between the frontend and backend.
	HTTP status	The numeric result of a request: 200 OK, 500 server error, 501 not implemented.
	TypeScript	JavaScript with type checking, so many mistakes are caught before the code runs.
	Vite	The dev server / build tool that runs the React frontend (http://localhost:5173).
	CORS	A browser security rule: the API must allow the frontend's origin, or the call is blocked.
Database	PostgreSQL	The relational database that stores the application's data.
	Prisma (ORM)	A library that reads and writes the database from your code, without hand-writing SQL.
	Model	The shape of a database table, declared once in the Prisma schema.
	Migration	A recorded change that creates or alters database tables.
	Seed	Code that inserts starter rows — here, the four request categories.
	Idempotent	Safe to run again with no extra effect; use upsert so re-running the seed makes no duplicates.
Testing	Vitest	The test runner for the frontend and unit tests.
	Supertest	A library that tests API endpoints by importing the app directly (no running server needed).
	Mock	A fake stand-in for a real dependency in a test, e.g. pretending the API call succeeded or failed.
	TDD	Test-Driven Development: write the test first, then write code until it passes (red → green).
Git & GitHub	Git flow	The branch discipline used here: feature branch → lab1-staging → main.
	Feature branch	A short-lived branch holding the work for one Issue.
	Staging branch	lab1-staging — the integration branch where features merge and are tested before main.

	Pull Request (PR)	A request to merge a branch; it is reviewed before it can be merged.
	Peer review	Your partner reviews your PR and approves it or requests changes.
	Issue	A tracked unit of work on GitHub (one per task).
	GitHub Project / Kanban	A board with status columns (Backlog ... Done) that tracks each Issue's progress.